



1. Is the column numeric?

Does it contain numbers that can be used in mathematical operations?



Numeric means the values are quantitative (int, float, decimal, currency, etc.).

No



Dimension

The column represents categories, labels, or attributes.

Examples:

- Country, Region, City
- Product Name, Category
- Customer Segment
- Date (e.g., Order Date)
- Status (e.g., Active, Inactive)

Yes



2. Does it make sense to aggregate?

Would summary operations (sum, average, count, min, max, etc.) produce meaningful insights?



Think about:

- Can we total it?
- Can we average it?
- Does summarizing help answer business questions?

No



Dimension

Numeric, but it does not make sense to aggregate (e.g., IDs, codes).

Examples:

- Order ID, Customer ID
- Zip Code, Phone Number
- Employee Number
- SKU / Product Code

Yes



Measure

Numeric and it makes sense to aggregate.

Examples:

- Sales Amount, Revenue
- Quantity Sold
- Price, Discount
- Profit, Cost
- Average Rating



Key Takeaway

If it's descriptive → **Dimension**

If it's numeric and meaningful to summarize → **Measure**